MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Tuesday, February 3, 2026

Date	Tuesday, February 3, 2026
Place	Senate of Virginia, Senate Chamber, State Capitol, Richmond
Length	2h 56m (video)

- Official floor video (Senate of Virginia, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i5qTBVjP8JM
- LIS Senate minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/S

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-18. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:12] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:01:17] Chamber.

[00:01:17] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:02:27] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:04:02] Chamber.

[00:04:57] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:07:01] Senate chamber.

[00:07:38] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:08:47] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[00:11:30] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[00:14:23] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:15:10] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:16:43] Senate Chamber.

[00:17:14] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:19:18] Senate Chamber.

[00:20:20] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:21:29] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:22:46] Senate Chamber.

[00:23:53] The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:26:40] Chamber.

[00:26:40] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:28:33] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:28:55] The Senate will come to order.

[00:29:51] The Senators will please take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The senators and all in attendance will please stand, if you are able, and be led in prayer this morning by the Reverend Sherman Z. Logan Jr. from the First Unitarian Universalist Church in Richmond, Virginia.

[00:30:15] And following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing and be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate Page Gavin Asby of Suffolk. Love Spray, spirit of life and love, known by many names and beyond all names, we come together at this opening of this session to pause, to breathe, and to remember why we are here.

[00:30:48] We gather across differences of parties, perspectives, and beliefs, yet united by the shared responsibility to serve the people of Virginia with integrity, courage, and care. Guide us with a wisdom larger than any single voice, a love wider than any single interest, and a justice that insists every person's dignity matter.

[00:31:13] In the choices made in these chambers, may the common good outweigh private gain, may compassion temper power, and may truth spoken even when it's hard. Grant us in humility, steady us with moral imagination, and call us towards a policy that protect the vulnerable, heal what is broken, and widen the circle of belonging.

[00:31:39] May this work bend towards fairness, this body towards cooperation, and this commonwealth towards a future where all can flourish. May this be so. Amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:32:29] The clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll.

[00:32:56] You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal from Monday, February 2nd, 2026. The senator from Roanoke moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their vote aye.

[00:33:13] Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 32, noes 8.

[00:33:32] Ayes 32, noes 8. The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the House of Delegates. the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax afternoon madam president good afternoon um i'd move the wave reading the communication of the house of delegates the question is shall the reading of the communication be waived all in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the house of delegates will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

[00:34:05] to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 32, noes 7. Ayes 32, noes 7. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor. We do not have any Madam President. We've now arrived at our time in the morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us today in the Senate gallery. And I give my daily

[00:34:44] reminder about our procedure. A senator will rise and provide an introduction for our guests, and I will then offer the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold applause until I have completed the Senate's welcome. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico.

[00:35:06] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, how are you doing this afternoon? Thank you. I'm doing well, Senator. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for an introduction. Senator has the floor. Madam President, members of the Senate, today's invocation was given by the Reverend Sherman Z. Logan Jr., and I asked him to stand. Sherman Z. Logan Jr. is the senior pastor of the first Unitarian Universalist church in Richmond. Reverend Logan is a native of Richmond, Virginia, a graduate of the University of Virginia, and the Samuel D. Proctor School of Theology

[00:35:42] at Virginia Union University, earning a master's in divinity in 2005. I ask that you please, Madam President, give him a warm Senate welcome. I thank the senator for that introduction. And Reverend Logan, you're no stranger to this chamber.

[00:35:59] We thank you for the many times that you have delivered our invocation. Your words of prayer are a real blessing upon this chamber. We thank you for joining us this morning. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Reverend Sherman Logan.

[00:36:23] The chair recognizes a senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Today in the gallery, we have representatives from Vacalo, the Virginia Coalition of Latino Organizations.

[00:36:41] They would stand there in the room. For more than two decades, Vacalo has stood at the forefront of advocacy for Latino families across the Commonwealth. Since 2002, this powerful alliance of community organizations has worked shoulder to shoulder to defend the rights, the dignity, and the well-being of Latinos and immigrant communities in the General Assembly in Virginia.

[00:37:06] Vacalo's mission is rooted in empowerment. They strive to ensure equitable treatment, to expand opportunity, and to secure fair representation so that every Latino in Virginia can thrive and be heard. Their commitment to civic engagement runs deep.

[00:37:22] For 23 consecutive years, including today, they have guided and mentored the next generation of leaders, ensuring that the Latino youth take their rightful place in the halls of power during Advocacy Day. Today, they come before this honorable body with a clear and urgent call to invest in the health and the education of our communities, to expand access to affordable housing, and to uphold the constitutional rights of families across Virginia.

[00:37:47] Their request is simple but profound. Support the policies that allow all Virginians, including our Latino and immigrant youth, to build a stronger and more just future. And I ask that you give them a warm welcome. I thank the senator for that introduction. And welcome to the Virginia Coalition of Latino Organizations.

[00:38:05] Thank you for the advocacy efforts that you are making, especially during this session, as you champion issues of priority around health education, and especially the work that is being done to nurture the next generation of leaders. Thank you for joining us today in the Senate gallery.

[00:38:25] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the Virginia Coalition of Latino Organizations. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, today is clean energy lobby day so if the folks that are here for that could please stand i am pro clean energy and so i'm very happy to be uh recognizing them but joining us today in

[00:39:02] the gallery are representatives from several of the renewable energy trade associations advanced energy united chesapeake solar and storage association coalition for community solar access solar energy industries association and the virginia distributed solar alliance that's a lot of words uh virginia's solar market is valued at 9.8 billion that's with a b and is home to to over 200 companies, that's a lot, that are leading the charge to decarbonize our electric grids, strengthen domestic supply chains, and invest in local workers.

[00:39:29] And so I hope you give them a nice Senate welcome. I thank the Senator for that introduction and welcome to our representatives from a variety of renewable energy industries. Thank you for the work that you are doing and the advocacy that you're providing on many of our legislative efforts that are ongoing this session.

[00:39:50] you for your leadership in this very critical area. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our partners in the solar energy industry rep as well as clean energy professions. The chair recognizes the senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I would like to welcome a group of Virginians representing the industries that serve us all at one time or another,

[00:40:29] the Virginia Restaurant, Lodging, and Travel Association. They're here on Capitol Hill today as a part of their annual day on the Hill. The VRLTA is the unified voice of Virginia's restaurants, hotels, tourism authorities, campgrounds, hospitality suppliers, and attractions.

[00:40:48] It was formed from the merger of several individual organizations in 1993 to provide a more central, potent voice for these industries, and today they compromise eight local chapters throughout the Commonwealth. As we know, tourism is one of Virginia's biggest industries, generating $35.1 billion in visitor spending in 2024. From running your favorite restaurants, to giving weary travelers a place to rest, to showcasing all Virginia has to offer, these men and women and their teams are making it happen every single day. Madam President, I hope it'll be the pleasure of the body to give them

[00:41:26] a warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And thank you to the representatives from the Virginia Restaurant, Lodging, and Travel Association. Thank you for the work that you do to ensure that Virginia continues to be a warm and hospitable place, not just for our visitors, but also for those of us who live in the Commonwealth.

[00:41:49] Thank you for all that you do for this particular area of our critical economy, especially our local economies. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the VRLTA.

[00:42:09] The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Senator has the floor.

[00:42:25] Thank you, Madam President. Today I am pleased to recognize the members of Envision League Grow Incorporated, who are joining us in the gallery today for their day on the hill. This is their first day on the hill. While here, these young leaders are learning about the legislative process and meeting with legislators from their respective districts, an experience that reflects their commitment to civic engagement, leadership, and public service.

[00:42:53] And they also got a special visit from the Secretary of the Commonwealth. Envision League Grow is celebrating its 10th anniversary, marking a decade of transformative work empowering girls and women through entrepreneurship, leadership, development, and economic opportunity.

[00:43:10] Founded in 2016 by Dr. Angela Reddix, the organization was built on the belief that every girl deserves the opportunity to dream boldly, lead confidently, and shape her own future. What began as a program serving just over 400 girls in seven high-poverty cities has grown into a nationally recognized initiative that has empowered more than 4,000 girls across 48 states.

[00:43:41] Today, Envision League Grow is proudly rooted in Portsmouth, operating from the Mustard Seed Place, a 33,000 square foot empowerment hub dedicated to innovation, collaboration, and community impact. Through research-based programming, residential summer immersion camps, family-centered entrepreneurship initiatives, and youth-led ventures like ELG Sweet Boutique that has the best ice cream in the Commonwealth.

[00:44:13] Envisionly Grow continues to cultivate confident, capable leaders who strengthen their communities. Madam President, it is fitting that we commend Envisionly Grow Incorporated for 10 years of distinguished service, visionary leadership, and lasting impact across the commonwealth.

[00:44:33] And with that, I ask that we give them the warm welcome of the Senate. I thank the senator for that introduction and we're hearing a lot about ice cream these days in the Senate chamber so there must be something in the air but thank you so much to the hard work of the leaders of Envision Lead Grow. Thank you for the opportunities that are being provided to our young women leaders and to the young

women who are part of this program. You continue to be an inspiration to so many. Thank you for your commitment to developing your skills, your talents, we're eager for you to take a leadership

[00:45:12] role in the future of Virginia. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of Envision, Lead, Grow. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Rise for an introduction. Senator has the floor. Madam President, ladies and gentlemen, the Senate, joining us in the gallery today are representatives from the Northern Virginia Chamber of Commerce, including their government relations staff, Clayton Medford, and Charlie Russ, and their CEO, Julie Koons.

[00:45:50] The Northern Virginia Chambers delegation this year includes leaders from companies such as William Hazel, Clark Construction, Deloitte, Anthem, Blue Cross Blue Shield, BF Saul, Comstock, Cooley, Dev Technology Group, Kaiser Permanente, Cox Communications, Verizon, UVA Health, Wells Fargo, and more.

[00:46:07] And Madam President, the Northern Virginia Chambers roadmap calls for the creation of a Northern Virginia economy that competes by design, not by default. They applaud us for our actions this session to increase housing stock access across the Commonwealth, as we all know, and affordable housing is a huge problem in Northern Virginia. I'm sure they're also here to talk to you about Metro funding and a little entertainment district some of us have an interest in. Madam President, I would hope you could give them the warm welcome of the Senate. I thank the senator for that introduction and welcome to NOVA Chamber of Commerce representatives. Thank you for being here and thank you for your advocacy on so many critical areas that are impacting our communities, not just in Northern

[00:46:47] Virginia but frankly all throughout the Commonwealth and I hope you have productive conversations with our legislators as you are visiting everyone's offices. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to NOVA Chamber of Commerce. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax. Madam President, good afternoon. I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you. Today in our gallery we have the Fund Our Schools

[00:47:23] a coalition this is a statewide coalition of organizations and individuals who are all united by one mission and one passion and that's ensuring that every child in the commonwealth of virginia no matter the neighborhood the zip code or their life circumstances that that child will have the highest quality education possible and they have lots of advocacy around adequate funding for our

[00:48:01] schools for ensuring a just and a compensation for our educators amongst many other priorities that will ensure that we have just the best schools and the best possible education for any child in the United States.

[00:48:22] So I thank them for being here and I hope you join me in welcoming them today. I thank the Senator for that introduction and thank you for the members of Fund Our Schools Coalition for your advocacy and hard work on behalf of our public education systems.

[00:48:39] thank you for speaking with our legislators and sharing your personal stories and your commitment to public education so that we do indeed have the best public education as the senator from Western Fairfax just shared that we have the best system here in Virginia. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the fund our schools coalition. The chair recognizes

[00:49:11] the senator from taswell thank you madam president i rise for the purpose of introduction the senator has the floor madam president today we are delighted to welcome the undergraduate students from virginia tech if they would stand they've joined us in the gallery as part of hokey day the annual tradition brings students from across the commonwealth to the general assembly to engage directly with legislators share their experiences at virginia tech and learn more about the important work that we do on behalf of Virginians. Throughout the day, these students have been

[00:49:50] meeting with members, visiting offices, and gaining a first-hand look at the legislative process in action. Their presence here today reflects a strong commitment to civic engagement and public service, and we are pleased to have them with us. I ask that the Senate join me in giving a warm welcome, and if you could give them a warm welcome, Madam President, I would appreciate for a Hokie guest I thank the senator for that introduction and welcome to Virginia Tech Hokies thank you for our student representatives who are here to share with all of our legislative offices the work that is

[00:50:29] ongoing at this wonderful institution thank you for representing your university and sharing your commitment to leadership and to the curricular studies that you are pursuing. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Virginia Tech Hokies. The chair recognizes the senator from Prince Edward. Thank You Madam President. I've rise to request a leave of absence for my

[00:51:06] seatmate the senator from Mecklenburg who's away on pressing personal business. The journal will so reflect. Is there any other business for the morning hour? Senator Prince William. Madam President, I move that the Senate recess until 1

[00:51:44] o'clock. Without objection, the Senate will be at recess until 1 o'clock. Madam President, if Senate Republicans could meet in our downstairs room immediately.

[00:52:02] Senator from Hampton. Madam President, upon recess if the Senate Democrats

[00:52:09] could meet in the back room. The Senate is at recess. The clerk will call the

[01:36:44] calendar. Senate calendar for Tuesday, February 3rd, 2026. Uncontested calendar, Senate bills on third reading. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that Senate bills on third read, uncontested calendar on pages 1 through 7, Senate Bill 165 through Senate Bill 713 be placed on the final passage in the block.

[01:37:10] Any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block may do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill the question is shall the Senate bills on the uncontested calendar third reading pages 1 through 7 Senate bill 165 through Senate bill 713 be placed upon their final passage in the block with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill all in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are now before us in the block.

[01:37:46] The clerk will read the number of the bills. Senate Bill 165, Senate Bill 184, Senate Bill 210, Senate Bill 269, Senate Bill 300, Senate Bill 309, Senate Bill 325, Senate Bill 338, Senate Bill 292, 392,

[01:38:17] Senate Bill 439, Senate Bill 577, Senate Bill 592, Senate Bill 597, Senate Bill 613, Senate Bill 633, Senate Bill 683, Senate Bill 699, Senate Bill 706, Senate Bill 713.

[01:38:48] The question is, shall the bills in the block pass? All in favor of the passage of the bills will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:39:03] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The bills in the block pass. Regular calendar. Senate bills on third reading.

[01:39:22] Senate bill 22, a bill relating to board of nursing continuing education requirements. The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton.

[01:39:41] Thank you, Madam President. I move that Senate bill 22 pass and speaking to that. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 22 directs the Board of Medicine and the Board of Nursing to require bias reduction training as part of their continuing education and continuing competency requirements for licensure and the research is clear implicit bias contributes to health disparities bias influences physician communication style and patient perception of clinical encounters

[01:40:14] and this negatively impacts care the 2026 version of this bill gives the clinicians more choices on how they address bias in their practice by permitting evidence-based training strategies that reduce bias implicit bias must be addressed in the first training but subsequent trainings can address topics such as cultural competency respectful communication understanding the history of racism in healthcare or another training whose goal is to reduce bias in healthcare the substitute that was adopted for this bill requires training on diseases and

[01:40:52] conditions including sickle cell disease that are racialized in clinical practice the substitute requires training that addresses how the inappropriate substitution of race based assumptions for individualized clinical assessment combined with implicit bias leads to delayed diagnosis inadequate treatment and disparate health outcomes and with that madam president I move the Senate bill 22 pass the question is shall Senate bill 22 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no

[01:41:27] are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the roll a sturdy nose eight Ayes 30, noes 8.

[01:41:43] Senate Bill 22 passes. Senate Bill 48. A bill relating to Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act. Landlord remedies non-compliance with rental agreement.

[01:42:00] Mandatory waiting period. The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill passes. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. We should be using every tool available to keep people safely housed, especially in a state that has the highest eviction rates in the nation the need is clear for better solution for tenants to avoid being evicted this piece of legislation gives tenants 14 days more time to get another paycheck perhaps borrow money from family or access

[01:42:35] rental assistance availability rental assistance available in their community i'm proud that this This has been a part of the current governor's affordability plan rollout. And I ask or renew my motion that the bill pass.

[01:42:50] Thank you. The question is, shall Senate Bill 48 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:43:09] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, Nos 18, Senate Bill 48 passes. Senate Bill 63, a bill relating to Board of Education requirements for graduation with an Advanced Studies Diploma,

simultaneous completion of International Baccalaureate Diploma, and Advanced Studies Diploma, approval of alternatives for certain credit requirements, regulations, report it.

[01:43:41] The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that the senator has the floor thank you madam president senate bill 63 removes a significant barrier for late transfer students such as military families or others who have spent part of the their school years overseas who previously had to double up on history and finance courses to meet virginia specific graduation mandates while at the same time completing the ib curriculum upon returning to virginia families are often surprised that they They need to satisfy additional requirements in the Virginia code in order to graduate

[01:44:20] on time. The goal of this bill is to ensure that as many students as possible can graduate on time from Virginia schools by granting the board of education a little flexibility in determining how these requirements must be satisfied.

[01:44:35] Again, the bill itself ensures that the students who transfer into Virginia public schools during or after the 10th grade and are pursuing the IB diploma it also ensures that the board must also approve which courses uh these sequences will satisfy those requirements with that i ask that we pass the bill the chair recognizes the senator from botton vatata uh thank you madam president uh will the uh gentleman from central fairfax central fairfax rise for a question

[01:45:13] will the senator yield i yield madam president senator from bata bata thank you madam president i'm wondering uh if uh if the gentleman would uh give some examples of the kind of courses that would be a substitute for because i'm i'm being not familiar with an international baccalaureate having not had a child in high school in a long long time uh i'm not familiar with that we're wondering what some of the substitute classes might be senator from central Fairfax madam president thank you and to the general to the gentleman so a lot of times the board can approve courses to satisfy history

[01:45:53] and social sciences courses financial literacy literacy courses and it is going to be up to the board on which courses that will be determined that they could replace those with senator I think I thank the gentleman the question is shall Senate bill 63 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all

[01:46:26] the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll it's 22 no 17 eyes 22 no 17 Senate bill 63 passes Senate bill 183 a bill to direct the Board of Health to promulgate regulations requiring restaurants to label any delivery or carry out food containing major food allergies. The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the bill pass and speaking to that

[01:47:03] motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. SB 183 is about public health, consumer safety, and clear communication. Food allergies are serious and increasingly common and for many families, managing those allergies one mistake can mean a medical emergency. Breakdowns in communication are most likely to occur with takeout and delivery orders when the customer is no longer present to verify that a meal was prepared as requested. This legislation ensures that when a restaurant agrees to accommodate

[01:47:38] a stated food allergy or sensitivity, that information follows the food to the point of consumption it is a practical safeguard that helps consumers make informed decisions and reduces

preventable harm the substitute in the bill the substitute before the body intentionally narrows the bill it applies only when a consumer has identified an allergy or sensitivity and the restaurant has altered or substituted the food in response the identification requirement applies only to modified items in carryout or delivery orders it does not

[01:48:14] create a universal labeling mandate, nor does it apply to standard menu items. Restaurants already manage allergen food, allergen information, and routinely label containers with order details and special instructions. This bill simply ensures consistency and accountability when an allergy-based modification is made. SB 185 as substituted is a balanced common sense step that protects consumers while respecting existing restaurant practices. I would like to note, Madam President, that this bill actually

[01:48:52] came from my chief of staff whose mother has celiac disease. She ordered takeout for herself and her parents. The menu identified a gluten-free option and in this case the three of them ordered the same menu item, except the mom's item was supposed to be gluten-free. When the food arrived, there was no label, no identifying marker, or anything to indicate which order was gluten-free.

[01:49:16] They just had to guess by tasting it to find out. Luckily, the mom guessed right, and all was well. However, that situation could have gone horribly wrong had she eaten the wrong meal this bill requires a practical and common sense method to identifying altered food for so many virginians who suffer from food allergies and also order takeout i move that the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 183 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes

[01:49:50] aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll.

[01:50:07] Ayes 22, noes 17. Ayes 22, noes 17. Senate Bill 183 passes. Senate Bill 194, a bill to direct the Board of Medicine and the Board of Nursing to establish continuing education requirements on the electronic death registration system for and require an attestation on the requirements of the timely signing of death certificates by physicians and an advanced practice registered nurses authorized to practice independently.

[01:50:46] - The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the SB-195 pass, and speaking to that motion. - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, SB-194 addresses a persistent failure by medical professionals to meet an existing legal obligation, the timely completion of death certificates.

[01:51:08] Every member of this body understands loss. We have lost a loved one. And when a loved one dies, families expect grief, not administrative paralysis. Madam President, I'm just going to wait until they stop talking.

[01:51:25] The Senate will come to order. Senator, may proceed. Thank you, Madam President. When a loved one dies, families expect grief, not administrative paralysis. Yet after a burial and after a service is paid for, after goodbyes are said, Families are routinely left in legal limbo because a doctor or medical office failed to do what the law already requires.

[01:51:52] Without a death certificate, families cannot access life insurance. They cannot settle estates or manage mortgages, benefits or basic financial affairs. These delays stretch into weeks, sometimes longer due to financial inaction.

[01:52:08] Federal funeral directors are licensed and regulated by the Commonwealth. They are subject to discipline, fines, suspension, and loss of livelihood and licensure. Doctors and their designees, however, are the sole parties authorized to complete and sign death certificates, yet they face no meaning accountability when they fail to act.

[01:52:30] Virginia law requires death certificates to be completed within 72 hours, yet compliance is inconsistent at best and ignored at worst. SB 194 requires the Board of Medicine and the Board of Nursing to ask, during licensure renewal, whether an applicant's scope of practice reasonably includes signing death certificates, and if the answer is yes, whether the applicant has viewed the existing online tutorial for Virginia's electronic death registration system.

[01:53:03] This training is free and accessible online. When licensed professionals repeatedly fail to meet legal obligations and no corrective action is taken, the General Assembly has a duty to intervene to protect families. Families want closure, not bureaucratic delays.

[01:53:20] Madam President, I renew my motion that this bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 194 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[01:53:35] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators wish to change their vote? - The clerk will close the roll. - Ayes 39, nos 0. - Ayes 39, nos 0. Senate Bill 194 passes. - Senate Bill 248, a bill relating to restaurants, food allergy awareness notice required.

[01:53:59] - The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass. I'm speaking to that motion. - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 248 is a simple, common sense, public health measure designed to help to one in 10 Virginians living with life-threatening food allergies.

[01:54:18] The bill directs the Department of Health to provide clear multilingual guidance for restaurant staff on safe food handling and cross-contact prevention. Restaurants would then post these notices in employee food prep areas, a standard practice that many restaurants are already implementing, as well as ask patrons to disclose any food allergies.

[01:54:39] Across the Commonwealth, our dining industry is a cornerstone of the economy. This measure provides our business with the tools to keep their customers and our constituents safe without imposing a significant admin burden. This bill passed the General Assembly last year with strong bipartisan support, and with that, I move that the bill pass.

[01:55:01] - The question is, shall Senate Bill 248 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:55:17] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 24, noes 15. Ayes 24, noes 15. Senate Bill 248 passes. Senate Bill 290, a bill relating to Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act enforcement by localities.

[01:55:35] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you so much, Madam President. I move that way past the bill, and I'm happy to speak to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 290 is legislation that allows when a landlord is found to be in non-compliance with their rental agreement and or there is a incident of a serious matter where the

tenants found to be in serious health endangerment and or there is a serious fire hazard that has been determined the locality in which the property is located may go ahead and take action on behalf of that tenant.

[01:56:15] And so I'm hoping that we can give these localities the additional tools that they need and move the legislation forward The question is shall Senate bill 290 pass all in favor of that motion? We'll record their votes aye those opposed. No are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted Do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll?

[01:56:43] 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. Senate Bill 290 passes. Senate Bill 341, a bill relating to private elementary and secondary school student codes of conduct policies relating to bullying and cyber bullying prevention and parental notification requirements. The chair recognizes the senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speak into the bill.

[01:57:14] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is a bill that will bring any bullying protections to Virginia's private schools. We already have them in our public schools, and this will regulate and require that each private school write anti-bullying policies with clear definitions, reporting procedures, and they train their staff so that they can recognize when a child needs help, investigate reports without delay and notify parents of bullying incidents. I think all of us in this room agree that parents have the right to know when their children are being bullied or are

[01:57:50] bullying others. I've been working with a family who's sadly lost their son who committed suicide after an event and the consequences are very high. Schools should be able to respond, intervene, and notify parents when these types of incidents occur so that further harm is not done and i move the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 341 pass all in favor of that motion will record

[01:58:23] their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk the clerk will close the roll eyes 34 nays 5.

[01:58:44] Ayes 34, nays 5, Senate Bill 341 passes. Senate Bill 351, a bill relating to certain civil arrests prohibited in courthouses penalty.

[01:59:00] The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill passed and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The bill before you today is about fundamental principles. access to justice our courthouses are meant to be the one place in the commonwealth where every person regardless of their background can walk through the doors and seek a fair resolution under the law but today those accesses are being undermined currently our halls of justice are being used as surveillance ground by federal immigration authorities in charlottesville

[01:59:36] chesterfield and across virginia we have seen a disturbance disturbing trend civil immigration arrest has increased over 300 percent just last year. More than half of those targeted were not even suspected of a crime. Think about the chilling effect this has on public safety.

[01:59:56] When a witness to a violent crime is afraid to testify because they might be deported from the witness stand, the criminal goes free. When a victim of domestic violence is too terrified to seek a protective water because of the agents waiting in the parking lot the cycle of violence continues we have reached a point where even court interpreters are avoiding our buildings for fear of being detained based

on the color of their skin senate bill 351 restores water and dignity to our courts this is a common sense measure it does not prevent law lawful arrest

[02:00:35] it simply requires that anyone wishing to make a civil arrest inside our court houses must identify themselves to courthouse staff, state their purpose clearly, and present a judicial warrant signed by a judge. This bill ensures that our sheriffs and clerks not masked unidentified agents remain in control of their own facilities. Madam President, with that, I hope this body will pass Senate bill 351 the question is shall Senate bill 351 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators

[02:01:14] ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 21 noes 18 ayes 21 noes 18 Senate bill 351 passes Senate bill 402 a bill related to residential property owners insurance policies roofing services by contractors prohibited practices and consumer protection the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax move the bill passes speaking to the bill senator has the

[02:01:52] floor the man president ladies and I said this bill got an abstention coming out of Gen Law's, I think, for Rule 36. But the short version is that bill prohibits insurance companies from denying or declining people's coverage based on their roofing.

[02:02:09] I think it's either five or 10 years old. And then it also has some practices to restrict these fly-by-night roofing companies that sort of zoom in when there's a natural disaster like a hurricane or a thunderstorm. And they offer to pay people's deductibles and end up getting people into roofing contracts they can't pay. The bill was otherwise unanimous other than that one rule 36 abstentions. I'd hope we could pass the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 402 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any

[02:02:48] senators desire to change their vote? Senator from, senior senator from Henrico. The clerk will close the roll.

[02:03:06] Ayes 38, no 0. Ayes 38, no 0. Rule 36-1. Ayes 38, no 0. Rule 36-1, Senate Bill 402 passes.

[02:03:24] Senate Bill 427, a bill relating to high school graduation requirements, history and social studies credits, certain substitutions permitted. Senior Senator from Henrico. thank you madam thank you madam president madam president i move the bill passed and i'd like to speak to that senator has the floor thank you madam president madam president sb 427 allows students to substitute the african-american history or ap african-american studies course for the world history one or world geography course in satisfying the history and social

[02:03:59] studies credit uh requirements if a course is available to that student i renew my motion that the bill pays the question is shall senate bill 427 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 23 no 16 ayes 23 no 16

[02:04:36] Senate Bill 427 passes. Senate Bill 701, a bill relating to Virginia Lottery, disclosure of identity of winners. The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass. And speaking to that motion...

[02:04:56] Senator has the floor. Under current law, we made a decision that the Virginia Lottery would not disclose information, personal identifying information, about individual winners whose prize exceeds a million dollars. But we've heard stories about people who won a lot or won only 800,000 or 900,000, which would be enough for me, to protect their privacy being invaded, people harassing them for money, people from creating social media accounts using winners' names and pictures under the pretense of giving away their winnings.

[02:05:33] So this just calls for one consistent policy for all lottery winners to be treated the same. Again, I move the bill to pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 701 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:06:06] Ayes 30, noes 9. Ayes 30, noes 9. Senate Bill 701 passes. Senate Bill 765, a bill relating to charitable gaming poker events.

[02:06:21] The chair recognizes the senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the bill to pass. Senior Senator from Prince William. I'd move to recommit this bill to the General Laws and Technology Committee.

[02:06:38] The question is? I withdraw. Sorry, wrong bill. The senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the bill to pass. Speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This legislation simply establishes clear operational boundaries for poker tournaments and individual games this bill allows for poker events that simply you can buy into the tournaments for up to the first two hours unlimited buy-ins and finally

[02:07:13] madam president it does not expand gaming it just simply works within a particular framework and allows for individuals to buy into events in their organization and madam president I simply ask that this man president is this bill pass senator there is someone in front of you I will recognize the senior senator from Fairfax and they are they funnier the senior senator from Fairfax holds the record on amusement the topic of this bill is charitable

[02:07:49] gaming does that mean that one has to be charitable by losing to make it Charitable Gaming? Madam President. Senator from Richmond City. I would simply suggest that's a difficult question and I'm barely able to keep a poker face. Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. Will the Senator yield for a question? Senator from Richmond City, will you yield? The Senator yields. Madam President, I would ask the gentleman, I know that we all have jobs outside of this very important job that we have, but Madam President, would

[02:08:27] the senator admit that he is a man of the cloth? Senator from Richmond City. Yes, ma'am. I would suggest and tell the senator I am a seminarian trained minister. Yes, ma'am. Senator from Franklin County. Will the gentleman yield for another question? Will the gentleman yield? Yes, ma'am.

[02:08:44] Senator has the floor. Thank you, ma'am. President, I'd ask the gentleman, being a man of the cloth, a man of faith, a man that tells us how we can find salvation, does he not believe that gambling is a sin. Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, in all seriousness, I don't believe we find anywhere within the written text that gambling is prohibited by the divine.

[02:09:14] Senator from Franklin County. Madam President, will the gentleman yield for one last question? Will the gentleman yield? Yes, ma'am. The gentleman yields. Being that I understand that we're

all following, we're all frail, we're all prone to sin. Does this bill of yours that you're trying to force upon the people of the Commonwealth of Virginia under the guise of charity are you not the kind, sir, then really forcing upon us a sin of the nation?

[02:09:48] Do you believe it? Senator from Richmond City. Did the senator understand the question from the senator from Frank and Quinn? I did understand and I would just say to the senator that at our church we don't judge as long as they tithe and so with that madame president i i moved the bill passed thank you madam president i do believe he needs a little more reflection

[02:10:23] a church that offers no judgment seeing no others who wish to speak madame president senate senior senator from prince william with the gentleman yield for a question will the gentleman yield yes madam president thank you line 64 of your bill i'll give you a moment to look at it uh if you could tell me what the first word is there madam president uh i fail to have uh that line

[02:10:57] if the senator would share with what the first word is senator from prince william uh madam president um i i yield from a question that i asked him to yield for is that what the senator Madam President, if I could, I do have it in here.

[02:11:18] Senator from Richmond City. I believe he asked, Madam President, line 64, the first word is jackpot. Thank you, Madam President. And so, if the Senator would yield for another question. Will the Senator yield? Yes, Madam President.

[02:11:33] Senator from Prince William. Thank you. What does jack have to do with pot? And is the Senator trying to slip in cannabis into this bill? Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, we are by no means attempting to infringe upon legislation that would allow or disallow pot, marijuana, or any other name that it is known by.

[02:11:55] Is the Senator satisfied with the answer from the Senator from Richmond City? I'm going to roll with it. So the last and final question. Will the Senator yield? Yes, Madam President. So I appreciate it, Madam President.

[02:12:11] I guess this is more of a serious question, but does the senator know when to hold them, know when to fold them, and know when to walk away, and know when to run? Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, in the words of the gambler, I would say, yes ma'am, I do.

[02:12:31] I know the song very well, and I know when to quit while I'm ahead, and I think I'm ahead right now, Madam President, so I would ask that the move, I would move that the bill pass. Prince William the senator has made the request that you sing the song for the chamber madam president I would love to show y'all my life below middle seat but I do not wish to tempt fate or infringe upon anyone's sensibilities with my lack of singing they allow me to preach on Sunday I don't get to sing at the church

[02:13:06] the chair recognizes the senator from Tazewell yes madam president I would like to speak on the bill. Senator has the floor. It says in the good book, Proverbs 28 and 20, "He that maketh haste to be rich shall not be innocent." The chair recognizes the senator

[02:13:39] from Alexandria. Would the senator from Richmond City, is it Richmond City, I believe? Would he yield for a question? Will the senator yield? Yes, ma'am. The senator yields. I notice you need to answer, but I noticed that you've been kind of keeping a poker face about this bill and not getting too excited. On a

serious note, does the bill require all players now to be 21 for the first time, 21 and over? Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I would answer the Senator,

[02:14:12] yes. There is an amendment that the age is 21. And further on a serious note, I'd... Senator from Alexandria. I'd ask the senator yield for one more question. Will the senator yield? Yes ma'am. The senator yields. Just to be clear this bill also forbids cash games which are susceptible to mischief or does it allow for cash games? It does allow for cash. Senator from Richmond. Madam president I would answer the senator by saying it allows for cash games within the organization not to just anyone that walks up off the street. Senator from Alexandria. I thank the

[02:14:50] gentleman. Madam President. Senator from Richmond. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass. The question, the question is, shall Senate Bill 765 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any

[02:15:18] senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, noes 8. Ayes 31, Noes 8, Senate Bill 765 passes. For those who may be joining us in the Senate gallery for the first time or watching the live stream, it is the tradition of

[02:15:52] the chamber that we give a new senator a very hard time. And this was the senator from Richmond City's very first bill in the Senate chamber and we express our congratulations on the passage of the first piece of legislation congratulations senator uncontested calendar senate bills on second reading the chair recognizes the senator from alexandria thank you madam president i move that all senate bills on the senate second reading of the

[02:16:30] uncontested calendar pages 12 through 16 sb 14 through sb 686 be advanced to their engrossment and third reading in the block after the adoption of any amendments thereto. Any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block, please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall all Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 12 through 16, Senate Bill 14 through Senate Bill 686 be engrossed in advance to their third reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments thereto

[02:17:07] that any senators desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the motion is agreed to and the clerk will read the number of the bills Senate bill 14 reported for the Committee on Rehabilitation and Social Services with amendment the chair recognizes the Senate the senior senator from Virginia Beach madam president I move to move the committee amendments the question is shall the amendments from the committee

[02:17:43] on rehabilitation and social services be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the amendments are agreed to Senate bill 214 reported from the committee on rules Senate bill 221 reported from the committee on transportation with a substitute the chair recognizes the senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Transportation be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:18:18] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 455 reported from the Committee on Transportation with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Virginia

Beach. Madam President, I move committee substitute the question is shall the substitute from the committee on transportation be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senate bill 485 reported from the committee on rehabilitation and social

[02:18:55] services senate bill 513 reported from the committee on rehabilitation and social services with amendment the chair recognizes the senator from charlottesville madam president i move that the committee amendment be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on rehabilitation and social services be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye aye any opposed no the ayes have it the amendment is agreed to senate bill 514 reported for the committee on rehabilitation and social services with amendment senator from charlottesville madam president i

[02:19:30] move that the committee amendment be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on rehabilitation and social services be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye any opposed no the eyes have it the committee amendment is agreed to senate bill 532 reported from the committee on rehabilitation and social services with the substitute the chair recognizes the senator from king william george george thank you madam president one of the kings move the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee

[02:20:07] on Rehabilitation and Social Services be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 550, reported from the Committee on Transportation with the substitute.

[02:20:24] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Transportation be agreed to? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Aye.

[02:20:39] Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed. Senator, this is in the uncontested calendar. Thank you, Senator. Senate Bill 573, reported from the Committee on Transportation.

[02:20:56] Senate Bill 686, reported from the Committee on Transportation. The question now is, shall the Senate bills be engrossed in advance to their third reading? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye.

[02:21:11] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills are now engrossed in advance to their third reading. Regular calendar Senate bills on second reading. Senate Bill 297, a bill relating to the use of photo speed monitoring devices repeal.

[02:21:32] from it's go ahead we reconsidered engrossment yesterday the chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William thank you madam president I move to refer to the committee on Senate finance and appropriations based on the substitute in a new fiscal impact the question is shall Senate bill 297 be re-referred to the committee on finance and appropriations all in favor of that

[02:22:06] motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the bill the bill is re-referred senate bill 306 a bill relating to use of violation monitoring systems to enforce traffic light signals and certain traffic control devices repeal we reconsidered engrossment on yesterday the chair recognizes the senior senator from prince william thank you madam president i also move that this bill be re-referred to the committee on senate finance and preparations for fiscal impact the

[02:22:41] question is shall senate bill 306 be re-referred to the committee on finance and appropriations all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the bill is re-referred senate bill 496 a bill relating to secure storage of handguns unattended locked vehicle penalty

[02:23:07] Reported from the committee for courts of justice with the substitute and there are five floor amendments. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. I rise for a motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move that Senate Bill 496 be recommitted to the committee for courts of justice. The question is shall Senate Bill 496 be recommitted to the committee for courts of justice. All in favor of that motion will

[02:23:39] say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is recommitted. Senate Bill 350, a bill relating to elections, absentee voting, processing, and counting ballots prior to the close of polls.

[02:23:56] Reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections, and there is a floor sub. The chair recognizes the senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the reading of the bill be waived the question is shall the reading of the floor substitute be waived all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the reading of the floor amendment the floor substitute is waived madam president senator has the floor thank you madam president president i move adoption of the floor substitute and speaking

[02:24:36] to that motion senator may proceed all right thank you madam president so if you go into your folders. You all got this one here. This was done a little workshopping from some election officials in my district. Also heard one from the senator from Roanoke. So thank you kindly for putting us in touch. And so this was to deal with some of the stuff that came up from members in P&E as well as from registrars. So let's talk about what it does. Number one, the amendment changes the date allowed to start processing returns back to the current seven days from 14 days, so we're now keeping that section of code. Nothing changes. And it reinstates that hand

[02:25:15] counting ballots at noon on election day is allowed, not mandatory. Next part. In regards to whether election observers could leak out totals or anything like that, what we've done is we've changed the time of the day that votes can, not shall, can be tabulated from noon to 5 p.m. on election day this gives our elected our election officials the choice to have a two-hour head start counting early votes and breaking them down by precincts this bill had bipartisan supporting committee but felt it was good faith to work with you know folks everyone who could and here's the goal matter president with

[02:25:53] this we want to be able to send people home early once they're done processing everything they should have a reasonable time to get home on election night and for the Commonwealth as a whole, we get our results in early. That means that people have less suspicion about what's going on when mail-in ballots are being counted and reported. Our numbers are coming out at 10, 11 o'clock your night. We're trying to get election night over with a lot sooner while making sure all the ballots are accurately, safely, legally counted. So Madam President, that is what floor amendments do. And again, I remove my motion to adopt the floor amendments. The question

[02:26:30] is, shall the floor substitute be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The floor substitute is agreed to. Senator from Western Prince William.

[02:26:48] Thank you so much, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question now is, shall Senate Bill 350 be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in

favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the bill is engrossed and advanced Senate bill 493 relating to consumer protection automatic renewal on continuous service offers disclosure and cancellations reported from the committee on general laws and technology with amendments there are a group of

[02:27:25] three floor amendments and then a group of three floor amendments the chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. With the recommendation that it be rejected I move the committee amendments. The question, with the recommendation that the amendments from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be rejected, the question is, shall the amendments be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. All opposed will say no.

[02:28:01] No. The amendments from the Committee on General Laws and Technology are rejected. Okay. Thank you. Madam President. Senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Um, now I move that we withdraw the floor amendments from yesterday, 1 through 3.

[02:28:19] Without objection, floor amendments 1 through 3 are withdrawn. Senator from Fairfax. Madam President, I now would like to waive the reading of today's floor amendment, uh, numbers 4 through 7. the question is shall the reading of the floor amendments four through seven be waived all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the reading is waived senator from Western Fairfax madam president I'd like to move today's floor amendments and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president so this um these floor amendments from today

[02:28:57] addressed some of the concerns and issues that the committee heard about small print newspapers where you may sign up at a booth at a carnival or something and them having the ability to provide an easy way for you to cancel so we've added a definition in there we have added language around just providing doesn't have to be as the same way to cancel the subscription but it

[02:29:29] has to be an equally easy way to cancel then I also heard the concerns that were brought up around ensuring that we are not picking favorites among FCC regulated entities and I did agree with that and so I am adding an exemption for FCC regulated entities from this bill and then lastly if you turn to the back

[02:29:59] side of the floor amendment that that is the good faith standard that the committee asked for and and it was in the original amendment so I'm keeping that and after you know doing all this work I hope we could all come to a place of support tomorrow but with that I do I engross in advance or do you know you have to I move it you move the floor amendments yeah the question is shall the

[02:30:37] floor amendments floor amendments four through seven be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it floor amendments four through seven are now agreed to senator from Western Fairfax now madam President, I'd like to engross and advance this bill to its third constitutional reading.

[02:30:59] The question is, shall Senate Bill 493 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 493 is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 17, a bill relating to enforcement of vehicle liens property value, reported from the Committee on Transportation.

[02:31:24] The chair recognizes the senator from Roanoke. - Thank you, Madam President. I ask that the Senate engrossed and advanced Senate Bill 17 to its third constitutional reading. - The question is, shall

Senate Bill 17 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading?

[02:31:41] All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no, the ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. - Senate Bill 135, a bill relating to Department of Motor Vehicles, Motor Vehicle Title Databases, reported from the Committee on Transportation.

[02:32:02] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Virginia Beach. Madam President, I move that we engrossed and advanced this bill to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 135 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:32:19] Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 218, a bill to direct the compact administrator of the Virginia State Council for interstate adult offender supervision and the director of the Department of Corrections to pause placements at Red Onion State Prison.

[02:32:42] Reported from the Committee on Rehabilitation and Social Services with amendments. - The chair recognizes the senator from Richmond City. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the committee amendments be agreed to. - The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee on Rehabilitation and Social Services be agreed to?

[02:32:59] All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The committee amendments are agreed to. Senator from Richmond City. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 218 be engrossed in advance to its third reading?

[02:33:18] All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 396, a bill relating to driver's licenses requirements for initial licensure, persons 18 to 21, reported from the Committee on Transportation with amendment.

[02:33:39] The chair recognizes the senator from York. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the amendment be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendment from the Committee on Transportation be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The committee amendment is agreed to. Senator from York.

[02:33:59] Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed and moved to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 396 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[02:34:18] Senate bill 426 relating to a alternate to alteration of suspension system and bumper Heights proof of compliance reported from the committee on transportation senator from Isle of Wight senator from Hanover madam president I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading the question is shall Senate bill 426 be engrossed in advance to his third reading. All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes

[02:34:57] have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 446, a bill relating to limited duration licenses, driver privilege cards and permits, and identification privilege card reported from the Committee on Transportation with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Transportation be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any

opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move that the bill be engrossed in advance to his third read.

[02:35:36] The question is, shall Senate Bill 446 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance Senate bill 506 a bill relating to vehicle equipment films on windshields reported from the committee on transportation with amendment the senator from Prince Edward thank you madam president I move the committee amendment the question is shall the amendment from the committee on transportation be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any

[02:36:13] opposed no the ayes have it the amendment is agreed to senator from Prince Edward. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 506 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[02:36:34] Senate Bill 583, a bill to amend the Code of Virginia relating to parking, stopping, and standing enforcement, bus obstruction, monitoring systems, civil penalties, reported from the Committee on transportation with amendment the chair recognizes the senator from central Fairfax madam president I move that the committee amendment be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on transportation be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye aye any opposed no the eyes have it the amendment is agreed to senator from central Fairfax madam president I move

[02:37:13] that the bill being grossed in advance to its third reading the question is shall Senate bill 583 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced Senate bill 595 a bill relating to mechanics and storage liens vehicle data reported from the committee on transportation the senior senator from Virginia Beach madam president I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading the question is shall Senate Senate Bill 595 be engrossed and advanced to its third reading.

[02:37:51] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 663, a bill relating to emergency vehicles exempt from certain traffic regulations reported from the Committee on Transportation.

[02:38:09] Senator from York. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 663 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[02:38:25] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance. Uncontested calendar. Senate bills on first reading. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that all Senate bills on first read on the uncontested and regular calendar, pages 22 through 25, Senate Bill 480 through Senate Bill 776, that the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading the titles be dispensed with the question is shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of Senate bills on the

[02:39:00] uncontested and regular calendars pages 22 through 25 Senate bill 480 through Senate bill 776 be dispensed with all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The

[02:39:30] reading of the titles is dispensed with. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the bills on, shall the bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on their second reading go by for the day all in favor of that motion will say aye

[02:40:06] any opposed no the ayes have it the bills will go by for the day regular calendar senate joint resolution on third resolutions on third reading senate joint resolution 60 confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the general assembly january 21st 2026 - Junior Senator from Virginia Beach.

[02:40:36] - Thank you, Madam President, I move the bill to pass. - Senator from King George. - Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the resolution. - The Senator has the floor. - Madam President, I would encourage all the members to vote for Senate Joint Resolution 60.

[02:40:58] As I understand this, this is the Governor's team. This is her cabinet that she's picked, her agency heads that she's picked, I think the governor has the right to pick the team that she wants to put her around her to move forward. And so though some may find one or another objectionable on this, I do think we have to respect the prerogative of the governor to put her team in place. So I'd hope that everyone would

[02:41:30] support this resolution. The question is, shall Senate Joint Resolution 60 be agreed to? All in In favor of that motion, we'll record their votes "Aye." Those opposed "No." Are the senators ready to vote?

[02:41:48] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their votes? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. Senate Joint Resolution 60 is agreed to.

[02:42:07] Junior Senator from Virginia Beach. Senate Joint Resolution 61: Confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the general assembly january 23rd 2026 junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president i move that the resolution be agreed to the chair recognizes the senator from hanover thank you madam president madam president speaking to the resolution senator has the floor madam president to put a little more texture on what we're doing here

[02:42:47] the last resolution we just had were for the governor, current governor, Governor Spanberger's cabinet appointments. And even though not all of my members agreed with all of the views of those appointments, they felt very strongly that when a governor is selecting the individuals to serve with them in the cabinet, that the governor should have the ability to put their team on the field. And even if they disagreed with some of them personally, they felt strongly that they should the governor should have that selection madam president this

[02:43:22] resolution is a little different this resolution regards three of our universities here in the commonwealth and madam president we've had this conversation and unlike the governor's appointments those of our former governor Youngkin have not been agreed to not because some of them weren't excellent individuals not because they had not spent time serving the Commonwealth not because their views were wrong but because of a political battle over universities and madam president we heard in the state of the

[02:44:01] Commonwealth that that battle over political universities not talking about the great accomplishments that have occurred there was going to stop but yet here we are again with a resolution replacing majority members on each of those boards. So Madam President, there are a number of

individuals on this list that I think are highly qualified and this is not a conversation about whether these individuals individually should serve but it is about how we do and

[02:44:39] confirm appointments. This body has the opportunity going forward even later today to make decisions that say we might not agree with every selection but we understand it's important when governors make those selections unless there's something really egregious about a selection about an individual person for to be able to confirm those so with that madam president I hope that

[02:45:13] we will stop playing political games with appointments and I hope that we will continue to or start focusing about affordability for Virginia but because of the these wholesale changes the members of my caucus are going to choose not to vote against them but choose not to vote on these selections the question is the

[02:45:49] question is so shall Senate joint resolution 61 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their votes? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 0. Ayes 21, noes 0. Senate joint resolution 61 passes. Uncontested calendar, Senate joint resolutions on

[02:46:22] second reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, move with all the Senate joint resolutions on second reading on the uncontested counter on pages 26 on page 26 SJR 12 through SJR 59 be advanced and grossman in third reading in a block at the adoption of any amendments thereto any senator desiring to move a resolution from the block should do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution the question is shall all Senate joint resolutions on second reading on the uncontested calendar on page 26 SJR 12 through SJR 59 be engrossed and advanced to their third

[02:47:02] reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments thereto that any senator desiring to remove a resolution from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will read the number of the resolutions. Senate resolution, Senate Joint Resolution 12 reported from the Committee on Rules with Amendment. The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton thank you madam president I move that the amendment be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the

[02:47:39] committee on rules be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the mo the amendment is agreed to Senate joint resolution 56 reported from the committee on rules Senate joint resolution 59 reported from the committee on rules the question is shall the Senate joint resolutions now be engrossed in advance to their third reading. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed no. The ayes have it. The joint resolutions are engrossed in

[02:48:12] advance to their third reading. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry of the clerk. Does that complete today's calendar? Yes sir. Is there any other business to come before the Senate? The clerk will report any announcements on the desk. Today, Tuesday, February 3rd, 2026. The Committee

[02:48:49] on Privileges and Elections will meet 15 minutes after adjournment, Senate Room B, GAB. The Committee on Agriculture, Conservation and Natural Resources will meet 30 minutes after adjournment in Senate Room A, GAB. The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Education will meet at 3.30 p.m.

[02:49:09] in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th floor, GAB. The Education and Health Subcommittee on Health will meet at 4 p.m. in Senate Room C, GAB. Tomorrow, Wednesday, February 4th,

2026, the Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Public Safety and Claims will meet at 7.30 a.m.

[02:49:36] in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th floor, GAB. The Women's Legislative Roundtable will meet virtually at 8.30 a.m. The Committee on Finance and Appropriations will meet at 9.00 a.m. in Senate Room A, GAB.

[02:49:54] The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11.15 a.m. in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol. The Republican Caucus will meet at 11.30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. Roses are red, violets are blue.

[02:50:10] There's only 10 more shopping days for you. the chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth change the time for public

[02:50:30] safety tomorrow 8:00 a.m. instead of 7:30 this is correction the Finance and Appropriations subcommittee on public safety and claims will meet at 8:30 a.m.

[02:51:03] tomorrow 8:00 a.m. gives you a few more minutes to shop online the chair now recognizes the senator from Portsmouth thank you madam president madam president I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow the question is shall the Senate now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow all in favor all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the

[02:51:42] motion is agreed to Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow

[02:51:48] Senate chamber be sure to stay connected with live sessions catch up on past

[02:53:14] meetings and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's

[02:53:18] YouTube channel. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

